

CUSTOMISE YOUR TECHNOLOGY

Want better productivity and faster browsing, then it's time to upgrade the technology you're surrounded with. For this, Lifehacker's quick guide to technology would come to your aid.

<http://lifehack.kr/uXtqlp>

HUMANS DON'T UNDERSTAND MODERN TECH

If you spend most of your time inside a web browser then chances are that you rely on your computer for pretty much everything. Here's an interesting article articulating this fact.

<http://bit.ly/tDSycy>

THE AGE OF UNSHARING

Don't we all just love sharing interesting stuff with our audiences on social networks? With so much information and data at our disposal, things might turn the other way around. At least the author of this article thinks so.

<http://tcrn.ch/sckARq>

QUESTION OF SUCCESSION

Kevin Rollins who served as a chief executive of Dell was replaced by the company's founder Michael Dell. Is it true that founders who stick for too long with the company tend to flush out new blood? Find out in this article.

<http://nyti.ms/u45x0G>

big part of your tablet experience, this is your tablet. Nook books for kids are full of animation and interactivity. They often offer read-along audio versions as well as the ability to record your own voice, if you want to read a distant child a bedtime story. (Recording your own voice is exclusive to the Tablet; it isn't on the Nook Color or the Kindle Fire.)

Nook magazines flip pages more smoothly than the Kindle, and when you double-tap on articles in the magazine page view, the text pops out in an attractive scrolling column. Magazines and books—especially cookbooks, from what I saw—can also incorporate embedded audio and video.

Compared with these, the Kindle's children's books look like cheap flatbed scans, its cookbooks lack panache, and its magazines look awkward.

The Nook's whole UI encourages you to keep reading. On the home page, the top status line lets you jump back to the most recent book you were in. A pop-down menu shows your most recently read books and magazines. An omnipresent small book icon at the bottom immediately reopens your book to where you left off.

Adult books are better than on the Kindle too, mostly through an interface with fewer mysterious icons and more clearly explained options. I also greatly prefer the Nook's accounting of pages and chapters over the Kindle's weird, disconnected "locations."

Barnes & Noble enhances the reading experience with its 700 brick-and-mortar stores, letting you read anything you want for an hour on the in-store Wi-Fi network, letting you browse physical magazines and tomes before buying them electronically, and offering up its staff to suggest books. Amazon has nothing to compete with that.

The one area the Kindle triumphs in is comics. The Nook has a limited selection of comics, and you pinch to zoom. The Kindle will

have Comixology as well as exclusive DC comics, double-tapping lets you flip through specific panels, and you can load a third-party comic reader if you have CBR-format comic files. That's a much broader comics experience.

... But It's Just a Bookstore

Barnes & Noble is a bookstore. It isn't a music store, or a video store, or an app store. And that's where the Nook Color falls short. Tapping on the music and video options just brings up a list of preferred third-party apps. There's no tightly integrated music or video store like on the Kindle or the iPad; in fact, right now there's no way to legally download videos to the device at all. (B&N says a downloadable video service is coming next year.)

You can stream videos from Netflix and Hulu Plus, and play music from Pandora and Rhapsody. This all functions just fine. But the Kindle has even better streaming options, plus downloadable music and video, and the Kindle's speakers are louder; the Nook Tablet's speakers can sound anemic at times.

The Nook Tablet also falls way short on apps. Sure, it has an app store, but you can count the number of apps in some categories on two hands; this is much, much smaller than Amazon's app store, which is, in turn, smaller than the Android Market. And unlike on the Kindle, Barnes & Noble is flat-out opposed to users running apps not available from its store. There's a workaround, but it's kludgier than sideloading on the Kindle, and Barnes & Noble could easily shut it down with a software update.

Barnes & Noble says it currently has more than a thousand apps, with a focus on games and children's apps, and it's adding hundreds each week. Fashion, cooking, travel, and health apps will especially ramp up over the next few months, the company said. But because Barnes & Noble is so intently curating its store, it looks

like there will just be less of a selection than Amazon has now, and over time.

The Nook store has some prominent, top-line apps, but its list is extremely shallow. While you can find Evernote, Pandora, Netflix, Hulu, Bejeweled, Flight Control and Angry Birds in there, I could only find 7 of 38 tablet-relevant top apps from our Top 50 Android Apps list. There's no IMDB, no Slacker, no Yelp and no Cut the Rope, for instance. It's a high-quality selection to be sure, but a very tight one.

You can load your own content if you have a Windows PC (there's no Mac compatibility), but only 1GB of the Nook's internal 16GB is available for files from your PC. (Another 12GB is available for files downloaded by apps on the device.) The answer: pick up a MicroSD card and slip it into the Nook's convenient slot (something you won't find on the Kindle Fire). You can use the whole card, up to 32GB, for your own data.

The Nook Tablet played our H.264 and MPEG4 videos at up to 1080p HD resolution, but no other video formats. Music played in AAC or MP3 formats either through wired headphones or through the tablet's somewhat anemic speaker.

Battery life, at 4 hours, 22 minutes of video playback time, was slightly shorter than the Kindle Fire, which scored closer to 5 hours, and is on the low side for a 7-inch tablet.

Networking, Web and Email

Like the Kindle Fire, the Nook is a Wi-Fi only tablet. Also like the Kindle Fire, the Nook connects to 802.11b/g/n Wi-Fi networks, but only on the 2.4GHz frequency band. The Nook comes with the standard Android 2.3 Web browser, which supports Flash, along with a POP/IMAP email program.

Read the rest of the article here:

<http://bit.ly/vDc7uj>